IMPORTANT CITIES OF THE UNITED KINGDOM

Grade 8 Social Studies | Sample notes

1. QUICK REVISION NOTES

1. BELFAST – Capital of Northern Ireland

- Capital and **largest city of Northern Ireland**; second largest city on the island of Ireland.
- Situated on the **River Lagan**; population about **286,000** (2011 census).
- Historic industries: Irish linen, tobacco processing, rope-making and **shipbuilding**.
- **Harland and Wolff** shipyard built the **RMS Titanic**.
- Home to the **Titanic Belfast** interactive museum.

2. EDINBURGH – Capital of Scotland

- Home to the **Scottish Parliament** and the seat of the monarchy in Scotland.
- Centre of banking for over 300 years: **Bank of Scotland** founded in **1695**.
- Tourism is a major mainstay: supports **30,000 jobs** worth £1.6 billion to the city economy.
- Famous for its stunning mix of architecture: medieval tenements, Old Town, cobbled wynds and Georgian-era buildings.

2. QUICK COMPARISON

- Belfast = Shipbuilding & Titanic (Lagan + Harland & Wolff)
- Edinburgh = Banking Capital of Scotland (Parliament + Bank of Scotland)

MEMORY TIP: Belfast builds ships; Edinburgh keeps the money.